

Certification of the weekday bus service change, Summer 2026 rating to Fall 2026 rating

To: MBTA Board of Directors From: Service Planning, schedule certification Date: 5 October 2026

Certified figure

The Board should certify a net increase of **+149 scheduled weekday bus trips** from the Summer 2026 rating (12,893 trips) to the Fall 2026 rating (13,042 trips), counted on a typical school-day weekday, Monday through Thursday, across all MBTA bus routes. **Route 65** (Brighton Center - Kenmore Station) drives the change at +45 trips, 86 to 131. Neither office's figure is certified: Finance's +321 and Service Planning's +121 are both rejected.

What each office counted, and why it is not certified

Finance, +321. Finance compared the first weekday schedule in the feed published as Fall 2026 (Monday 24 August, 12,721 bus trips) with the Fall count of 13,042. That August weekday is still the Summer rating, and it is a no-school day: the Summer rating does not switch to its school-day weekday schedule until 31 August, and the Fall rating itself does not begin until 6 September. Comparing a no-school Summer weekday with a school-day Fall weekday counts the 172 school-day trips as if the Fall rating added them. On a like-for-like school-day basis the Summer count is 12,893, not 12,721.

Service Planning, +121. Service Planning counted each route's timetable as it is published, which lists a trip under every route it serves, so a trip that runs as a combined route appears in two route counts. That is the right way to print a timetable and the wrong way to count system trips: it gives 13,128 and 13,249 instead of 12,893 and 13,042, and the route rows no longer add to the system total. Counting every trip once, under its own route, the change is +149.

How the certified figure was built

The archive index assigns the feed published 21 August 2026 to every date from 21 August onward, so both comparison days were taken from that one feed, and the Summer day was re-run on the feed published 12 August to confirm an identical route register. The Summer day is Wednesday 2 September 2026 and the Fall day is Wednesday 23 September 2026: both are Monday to Thursday school days on which every active service is flagged as a typical schedule, with no holiday, modified, or reduced service in effect. Trips were counted by the services actually active on each date rather than by the rating label on the service, because several long-running services labelled Spring/Summer continue to operate under the Fall rating. The route population is every route the feed classifies as Frequent, Local, Coverage, Commuter, or Supplemental Bus; rail replacement shuttles, which the feed also stores as bus-type routes, are excluded, and none operated on either comparison day. School-day supplemental trips are included on both days because the Board's convention is a school-day weekday. Each trip is counted once under its own route.

Routes whose weekday count changed, ranked by size of change

Rank	Route	Category	Summer	Fall	Change
1	65	Local Bus	86	131	+45
2	465	Local Bus	0	32	+32
3	70	Local Bus	147	172	+25
4	222	Local Bus	62	83	+21
5	220	Local Bus	62	81	+19
6	66	Frequent Bus	232	247	+15
7	26	Local Bus	82	72	-10
8	SLW	Frequent Bus	61	53	-8
9	16	Local Bus	208	215	+7
10	34	Local Bus	98	92	-6
11	504	Commuter Bus	72	66	-6
12	35	Local Bus	70	73	+3
13	435	Local Bus	35	38	+3
14	7	Local Bus	147	149	+2
15	24	Local Bus	67	65	-2

Rank	Route	Category	Summer	Fall	Change
16	28	Frequent Bus	204	206	+2
17	32	Frequent Bus	300	302	+2
18	34E	Local Bus	78	80	+2
19	41	Local Bus	49	51	+2
20	44	Local Bus	102	100	-2
21	116	Frequent Bus	253	255	+2
22	216	Local Bus	145	147	+2
23	553	Local Bus	40	38	-2
24	9	Frequent Bus	204	205	+1
25	10	Local Bus	85	84	-1
26	39	Frequent Bus	230	229	-1
27	77	Frequent Bus	188	189	+1
28	436	Local Bus	32	33	+1
All bus routes 152 routes			12,893	13,042	+149

The 124 other bus routes run the same number of weekday trips under both ratings. The 28 changes above sum to +149, which ties exactly to the two system counts in route_service_change.csv.

School-day supplemental trips

Of the 12,893 Summer trips, 137 are school-day supplemental trips; of the 13,042 Fall trips, 138 are. The supplemental service is almost unchanged between ratings and explains +1 of the +149.

Route 65: what changed

Under the Summer rating Route 65 ran 86 weekday trips, with the first scheduled departure at 05:58 and the last scheduled arrival at 21:03. Under the Fall rating it runs 131 weekday trips, first departure 05:00 and last arrival 25:33 (1:33 a.m. the next day). The route was extended at its inbound end: Summer inbound trips terminate at Kenmore (headsign Kenmore) and Fall inbound trips terminate at Ruggles, with the span of service opening about an hour earlier and closing more than four hours later. The added trips come from the longer span and more frequent service across the day rather than from any change to the Brighton Center end of the route.

How close the driving route is to being overtaken

Route 465 (Danvers Square - Salem Depot via Liberty Tree Mall) is the runner-up at +32, 13 trips behind Route 65. The smallest change in a single route's Fall count that would make a different route the driver is **14 trips**: Route 465 would become the driver with 46 Fall trips (+46), or Route 65 would lose the lead at 117 Fall trips (+31). No other route is within reach: the third-largest change is +25 on Route 70.

Why no other figure survives

The Board's convention fixes the day type, the day-of-week band, and the population, and the feed fixes which services run on a given date. Once those are applied there is exactly one Summer register and one Fall register, both stable across every qualifying day in their rating and identical across the two archived feeds that cover them. Every alternative figure comes from relaxing one of those fixed points: a no-school day, a Friday, a holiday, a rating label instead of a date, a timetable listing instead of a trip, or a shuttle instead of a bus route. +149 is the only number the convention and the files allow, and Route 65 is the only route that can be named as its driver.